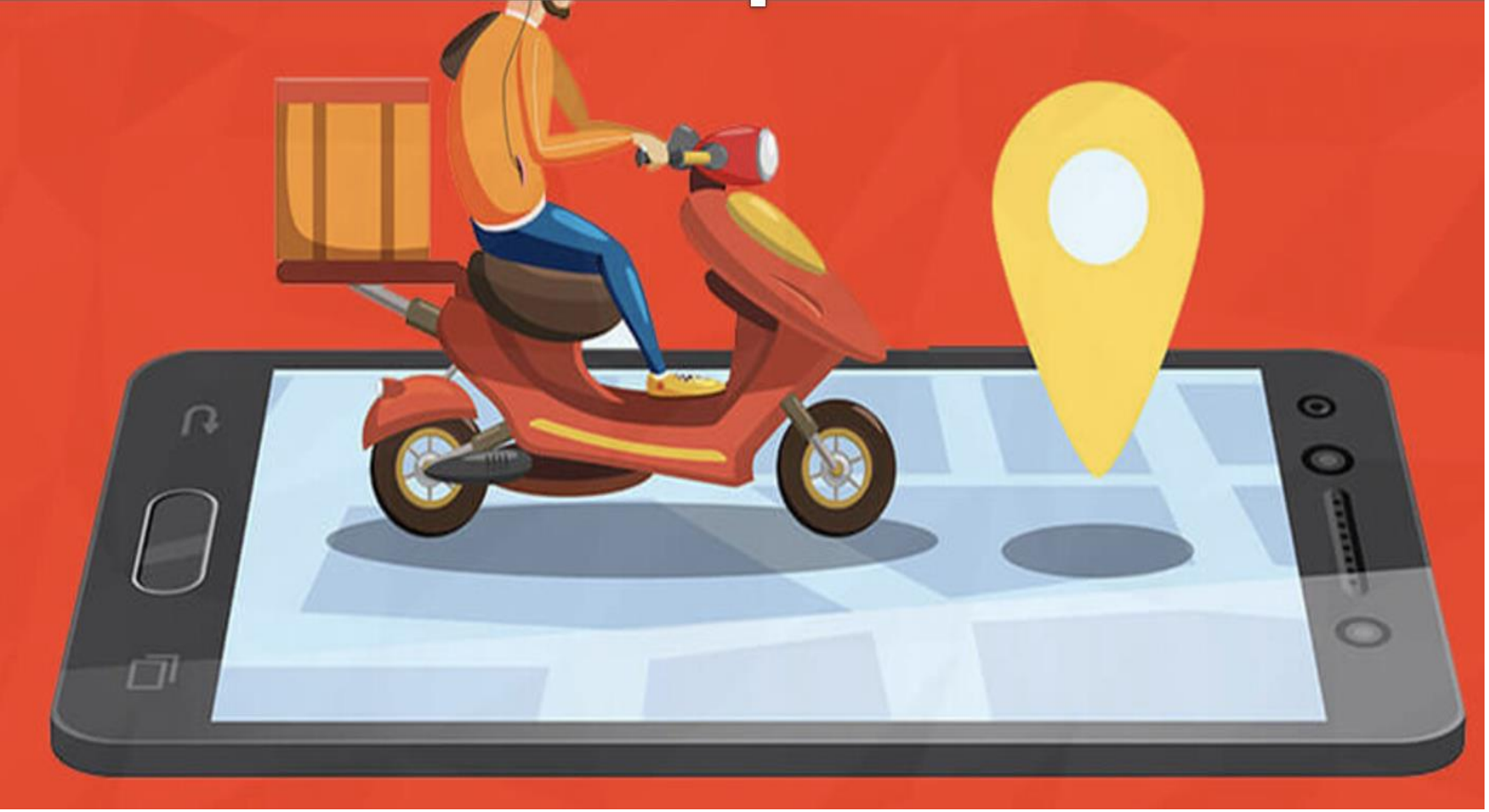


DOORDASH

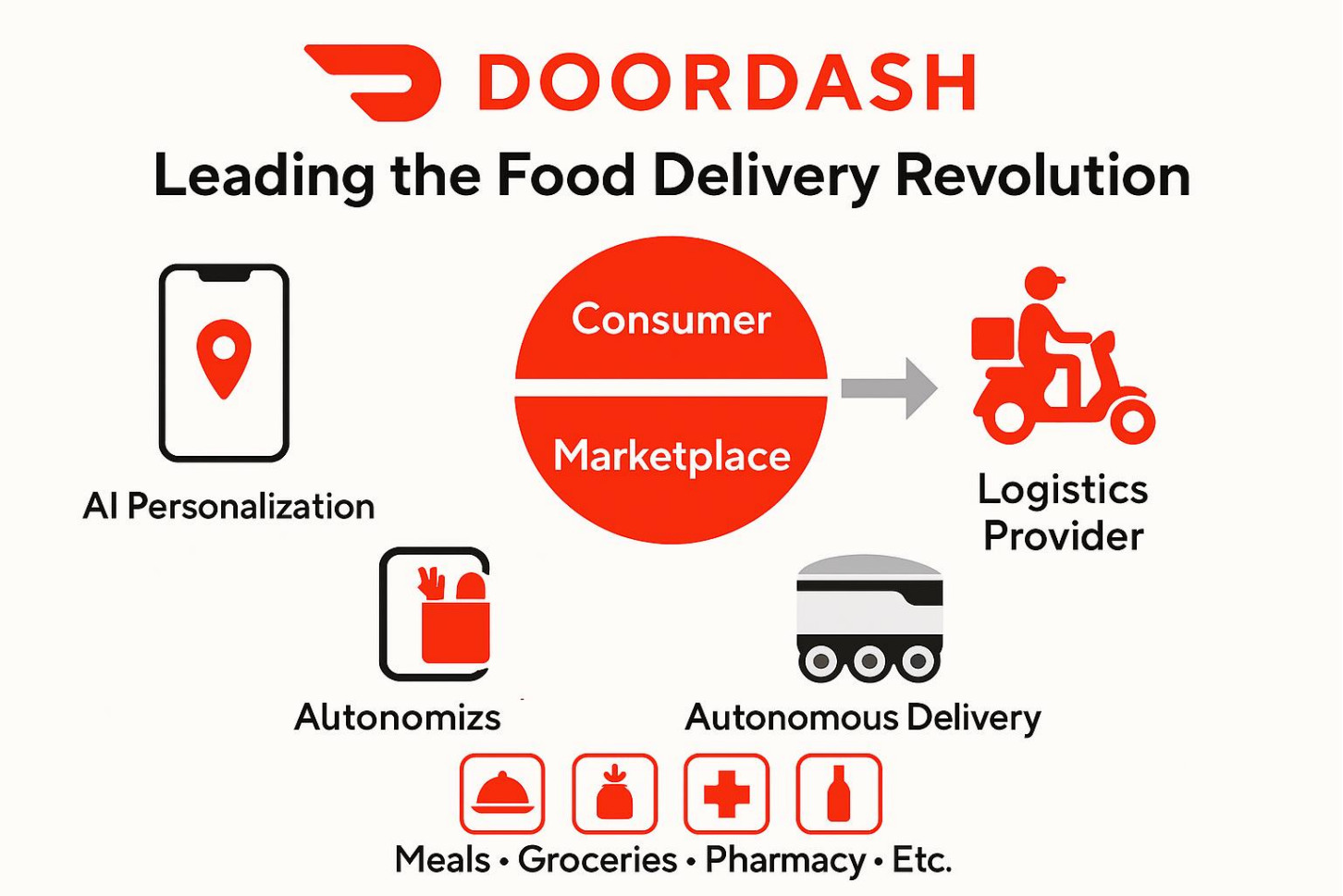
Delivering the Future: DoorDash's Dominance in the Food Delivery Landscape

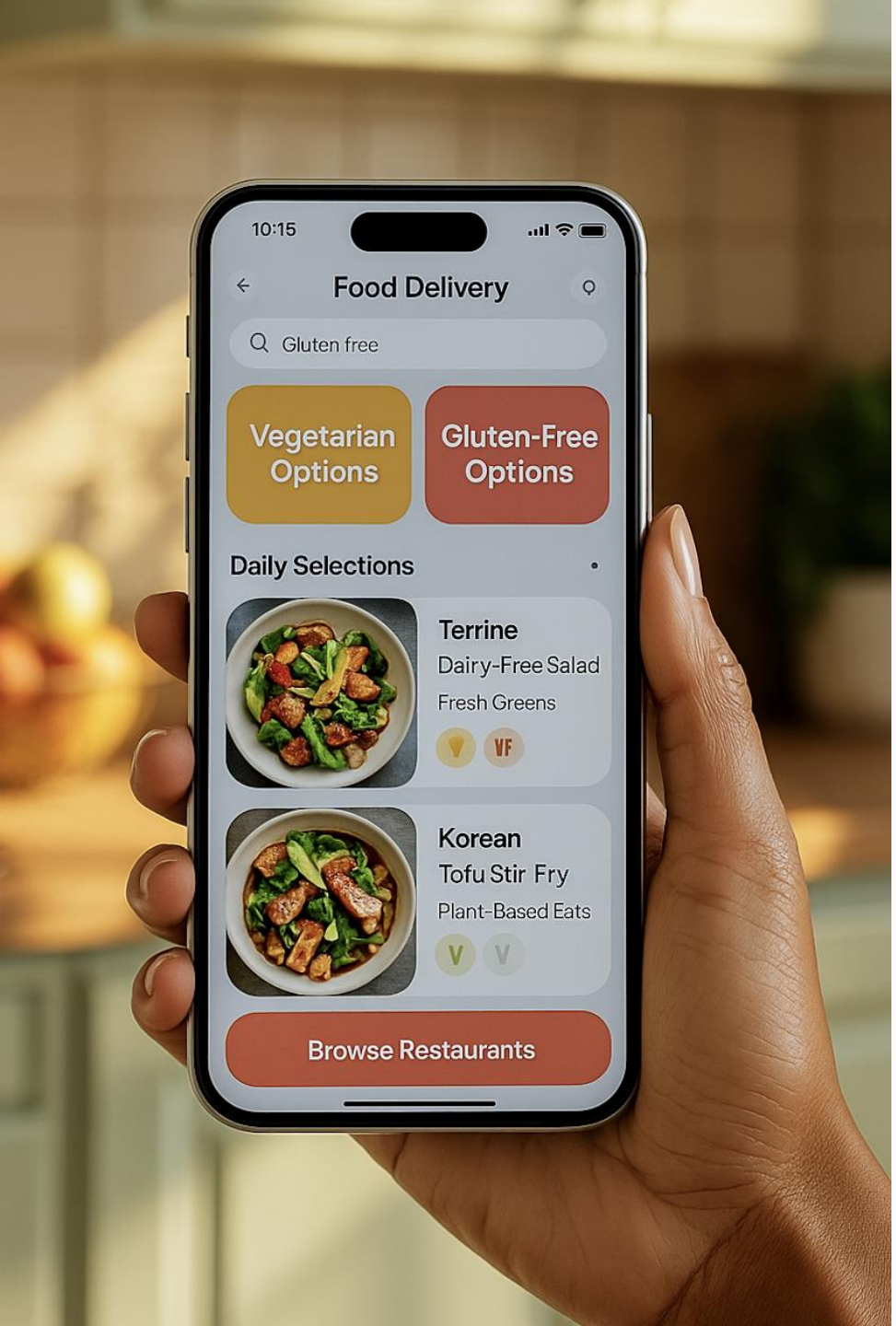
Durga Prasanna Kumar Melam

DoorDash - Leading the Food Delivery Revolution

- Market Leader: **67%** U.S. meal delivery share
- Revenue: **$10.72 billion** in 2024 (+24% YoY)
- Customers: **42 million** active users

Driving growth through innovation and consumer engagement





Building Better Food Filters: Enhancing DoorDash's Dietary Preferences Experience

Understanding User Needs & Personas

Accurate Dietary Options

Users need reliable filters to find meals meeting specific dietary requirements (gluten-free, dairy-free, vegetarian)

Clear Communication

Transparency about dietary tag accuracy builds trust and reduces disappointment

Reliable Functionality

Filters must work correctly without glitches or misleading results

Efficient Search

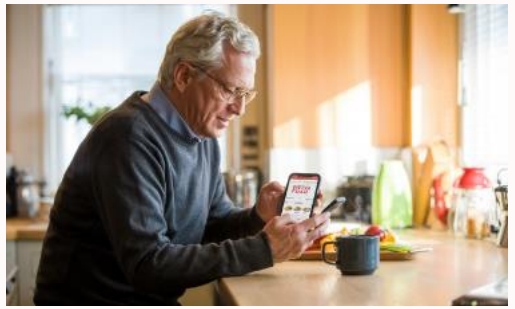
Users want faster paths to suitable meals without excessive manual searching

Key Target Personas

Michael Thompson

The Retired Frequent Traveler

67-year-old retired airline operations officer with food allergies (gluten, lactose)



- Needs confidence in allergy-safe meals
- Struggles with menu confusion
- Values reliability over speed

Zoe Nguyen

Budget-Savvy Graduate Student

25-year-old computer science master's student with vegetarian diet preferences

- Needs quick vegetarian meal discovery
- Frustrated by manual filtering
- Values efficiency and affordability

User Pain Points & Supporting Evidence

Inaccurate Results

Vegetarian filters showing non-vegetarian options

Unclear Labeling

Confusion about what dietary tags mean

Time Waste

Excessive manual searching for suitable options

Filter Glitches

Technical issues causing filter failures

Our Voice of Customer (VOC) research confirms these pain points are significant. In our survey (N=25), "Accurate Dietary Options" received an average importance rating of 4.2/5, making it a top three customer priority. Qualitative interviews revealed frustration with inconsistent filtering results.

MVP: Clear Solution to Drive Growth and Trust

Goal: Enable users to easily find meals matching their dietary needs, while boosting DoorDash's trust and conversion rates.

Approach: Launch user-friendly, transparent, and scalable filtering system with minimal operational disruption.

Problem

Users with dietary needs are underserved → lost orders, lost trust.

Solution

Launch simple, reliable Dietary Filters that solve a Top 3 user need

Outcome

Faster ordering, higher user loyalty, increased order volume

Core Features to Win the Market

1. Dietary Filters

- Dropdowns for "Vegetarian", "Gluten-Free", "Dairy-Free" at restaurant & grocery level
- Saves user preferences for future searches
- Fits into existing search flow without disruption

2. Restaurant Tagging

- Restaurants tag items with dietary labels
- Highlights allergy-safe and preferred options
- Boosts partner visibility in search results

3. Education and Disclaimers

- Short tooltip: "Labels provided by restaurant partners"
- Sets expectations, reduces legal risk
- Builds trust while protecting DoorDash legally

Why This Approach Wins

Minimal Engineering Lift

- No major AI backend overhaul needed at launch

High User Impact

- 4.2/5 average importance rating among surveyed users (Top 3 user need)

First Mover Advantage

- Uber Eats and Instacart offer limited dietary filtering today

Truth & Conversion

- Safer choices drive more completed orders, higher LTV

Success Metrics to Track

KPIs to implement on Day 1:

Filter Usage (Monthly Active Users engaging with Dietary Filters)

Order Conversion Rate (with filters applied)

Average Order Value (for users applying filters)

Restaurant Tag Adoption Rate (percent of menus tagged)

These KPIs directly measure user adoption, order growth, and partner engagement. Helping to prove the feature's impact on both customer experience and business revenue.

How We Will Measure Success

Current conversion rate: 4.5% (percentage of app users who place an order)
Minimum Detectable Effect: 15%
Sample Size: 23.3K users
Duration: 2-3 weeks
Significance Level: 0.05; **Statistical Power**: 0.8
Guardrail Metrics: Weekly Support Tickets/WAU, Usage of Preexisting Filters, Filter Repeat Usage Rate

- Peeking
- Spillover

- Commit to a minimum test duration of 2-3 weeks
- Ensure proper randomization and limit marketing and communications about the feature during testing

Roadmap

August 2025

Phase 1: Pilot Launch

- Launch Dietary Filters MVP to 10% of users in 2 key metro markets
- Include Education & Disclaimers at the point of search and checkout
- Monitor KPIs: Filter Usage Rate, Order Completion Rate, User Feedback

October 2025

Phase 2: Beta Expansion

- Expand to 40% of users nationally
- Start Restaurant Partner Tagging Program (tag menus for dietary labels)
- Refine UX based on pilot learnings

December 2025

Phase 3: Full Launch

- Roll out to 100% of users
- Introduce Filter Preference Save option (auto-save dietary preferences)
- Launch marketing push to promote new filter feature

February 2026

Post-Launch Optimization

- Improve partner tagging accuracy through training
- Add more dietary categories (e.g., nut-free, vegetarian)

Measuring Success and Mitigating Risks for Launch

Key Success Metrics

- Increase filter usage rate by 25% in 3 months
- Boost filtered order completion rate by 15%
- Achieve 4.5+/5 CSAT score for filter users
- 90%+ restaurant tagging compliance

Risk and Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation Strategy
Inaccurate Partner Tagging	Launch **mandatory partner training** + conduct **monthly audits** to ensure tag accuracy. Implement a **flagging system** for users to report mislabeled items.
Low User Adoption	Integrate **in-app tutorials** and **promotional banners** highlighting the filter benefits. Leverage **personalized email campaigns** targeting users with prior dietary search history.
User Confusion About Tags	Use **simple tooltips** with everyday language at search and checkout points. Validate wording through **early usability testing** to minimize misunderstanding